

INSTITUTE OVERVIEW | SEPTEMBER 2026

OEI Institute Overview

Operational Forensics for Growing Teams

The Institute governs. OEI is the methodology.

The OEI Institute maintains the methodology's canon, definitions, evidence and practice standards, and deliberate evolution. OEI gives teams a shared framework for investigating how operational strain develops as organizations grow.

What the Institute does

Govern

Maintain the established method and its practice standards.

Develop

Build practitioner capability and pathways for responsible application.

Support

Maintain documentation, workflows, tools, and software.

The five OEI pillars

Founder Dependency

Key-person reliance

Knowledge Logistics

Information access and movement

Workflow Velocity

How work moves

Tool Discipline

How tools support work

Handoff Integrity

Transfer of ownership and context

A method for responsible application

Operational forensics examines work as it functions in practice. OEI combines interviews, workflow observation, records, operational samples, and structured analysis to distinguish observation from interpretation, test explanations, and support action grounded in evidence.

AI Enablement Through OEI

AI Enablement is one way to begin when an organization has an AI initiative or mandate and needs to know whether AI can improve consequential work. It can also follow OEI findings as a justified intervention. AI is not an OEI pillar, and the evidence may support changing course or not proceeding.

OEI uses two distinct roles. Researchers prepare traceable evidence. Practitioners interpret that evidence, diagnose, and guide action. Company-Sponsored trains two people for \$10,000. Independent Consultant trains one person for both roles for \$12,000. OEI Native qualifies a Practitioner for Institute delivery for \$15,000. The 60% training and assessment payment is upfront and non-refundable. Passing earns certification and authorization. The 40% balance is due only after passing. First-year renewal is waived. Annual renewal is \$500 per internally employed Company-Sponsored Practitioner, \$600 for Independent Consultants, and \$750 for OEI Native Practitioners. Researchers have no renewal fee. Full terms: operationalentropy.com/practitioner-development/.